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UAE Presidential Court

UAE, CYPRUS PRESIDENTS DISCUSS WAYS TO ENHANCE COOPERATION

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan is received by Nikos Christodoulides, President of Cyprus, at the Presidential Palace in Nicosia during an official visit yesterday. The leaders held discussions focused on enhancing cooperation as part of the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership between the two nations.

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SPECIAL REPORT

UAE's most dynamic business leaders & CEOs in profile

UAE tightens law on sexual offences and prostitution

MINIMUM 10 YEARS IN JAIL, DH100,000 FINE FOR VIOLATION

DUBAI

BY ANUPAM VARMA
News and Business Editor

The UAE government has announced a new federal decree-law that tightens penalties for sexual offenders involving minors, and prostitution.

The amendments also enhance the judiciary's ability to assess the criminal risk of offenders convicted in certain serious crimes, allowing authorities to subject the convicted person to medical, psychological and social examinations during the last six months of their sentence.

Stiff penalties

The decree-law introduces stricter penalties for offences involving sexual assault or consensual sex with minors. It stipulates that any person who has completed 18 years of age and engages in sex with a female, or engages in sexual activity with a person of the same sex, who is under 18 years of age, shall be punished by imprisonment for not less than 10 years and a fine of not less than Dh100,000, even if consent is alleged. The decree-law clarifies that consent shall not be recog-

The amendments also enhance the judiciary's ability to assess the criminal risk of offenders convicted in certain serious crimes.

nised unless the victim has completed 16 years of age.

The amendments also stipulate that individuals under 18 years of age involved in consensual sexual acts shall be subject to the provisions of the Juvenile Delinquents and Juvenile at the Risk of Delinquency Law, whether the offender is male or female and regardless of the sex of the other party.

The amendments also strengthen penalties for offences involving incitement, solicitation or enticement to debauchery or prostitution. The penalty shall be imprisonment for not less than two years and a fine. The punishment is increased to imprisonment and a fine where the victim is a minor under 18 years of age, ensuring strong protection for children.

Apart from assessing criminal risk of offenders, the amendments also authorise the Public

Prosecution, whenever it deems it necessary, to submit a request to the competent court that issued the sentence to impose additional precautionary measures on the offender after serving the complete original penalty, if the offender's continued criminal risk is established and such measures are necessary to preserve public safety.

Public safety measures

These measures may include placement in rehabilitation centres, placement in therapeutic facilities, or submission to supervision or electronic monitoring. The amendments grant the court, upon a request by the Attorney General, the authority to suspend execution of custodial sentences in certain offences affecting state security, provided there are serious grounds to justify confidence in the offender's reform.

The court may also revoke the suspension order and return the offender to the correctional facility to serve the remaining sentence, upon a request by the Attorney General, if the offender breaches any court-imposed conditions or commits a new intentional offence during the term of the measure.

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